

Khristian Gaines

Senior Software Engineer · Systems & Backend

Focused on backend architecture, automation, and integration-heavy systems.

Washington, DC

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Summary

Senior Software Engineer with 10+ years building backend systems, APIs, automation workflows, and integration-heavy platforms across consulting, enterprise, and startup environments.

Experienced designing systems that transform messy real-world inputs into reliable, structured, automated outcomes — including data pipelines, deployment tooling, workflow systems, and LLM-powered automation.

Core strengths include backend architecture, integrations, automation, production reliability, and end-to-end system delivery.

Core Stack

Ruby on Rails · PostgreSQL · REST APIs · AWS · Python · Docker · Redis / Sidekiq · LLM APIs

Focus Areas

Backend Architecture · Automation · Integration-Heavy Systems · Data Pipelines · Workflow Systems · LLM-Powered Automation

Professional Experience

Principal Consultant — Faster Agile

2015 – Present

Led delivery of backend systems and integrations across client teams. Defined architecture, built APIs and pipelines, and owned reliability in production.

- Delivered 8–10 production systems across web, API, and integration-focused projects
- Led engineers on IoT data pipeline initiatives involving AWS ingestion and telemetry processing
- Built AWS-backed pipelines and APIs for ingestion, processing, and automation workflows
- Owned end-to-end delivery from technical scoping through production support
- Designed systems focused on reliability, maintainability, and operational simplicity

Selected Consulting Work

IoT Data Pipeline

Designed AWS-based pipeline to decode and process cellular fleet telemetry data.

- Routed event streams through AWS Kinesis for scalable ingestion
- Persisted decoded telemetry data into DynamoDB
- Exposed processed data through Python-backed APIs and Lambda functions
- Led engineers supporting ingestion and telemetry processing initiatives

Senior Rails Engineer — Best Buy

2022 – 2023

Built deployment tooling and integrations supporting CI/CD and production change workflows.

- Automated ServiceNow change requests for deployments
 - Enabled API-driven releases to AWS Kubernetes environments
 - Improved deployment reliability and reduced manual operational steps
 - Used Jenkins, Splunk, and Dynatrace to support deployment visibility and troubleshooting
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Senior Software Engineer — Dutchie / Leafly

2019 – 2022

Built and maintained APIs and integrations supporting operational workflows and customer-facing systems.

- Developed Rails APIs for menu and order integrations
 - Improved menu data accuracy by replacing brittle key/value lookups with regex-based parsing for POS-synced inventory and pricing
 - Reduced mismatches between in-store POS updates and web menu representation
 - Supported rollout strategies, production monitoring, and operational reliability
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Selected Projects

Cycling Coach Agent

AI-powered coaching system that automates training analysis, planning, and performance feedback using Intervals.icu data.

- Runs daily, polling Intervals.icu to automatically ingest new ride data
- Generates post-ride analysis and recommendations within ~30 minutes
- Writes structured training sessions back to Intervals.icu based on athlete goals
- Monitors workout execution and evaluates performance against planned targets
- Replaced ad-hoc riding with structured, goal-driven training that adapts based on historical performance

Technologies

Python · APIs · Automation · LLM Workflows · Intervals.icu

Email Action Extraction System

System that converts unstructured email into structured, actionable workflows with shared visibility.

- Built ingestion pipeline (SES → S3 → Lambda → Postgres) for reliable email capture
- Parses participants to extract tasks, owners, and follow-ups from variable email formats
- Creates shared dashboard of actions visible to all participants
- Replaced manual email triage and task entry with automated, structured tracking
- Enables clear ownership and follow-up by showing what's done, by whom, and what remains pending

Technologies

AWS SES · S3 · Lambda · PostgreSQL · Ruby on Rails · Workflow Automation

Engineering Approach

What do you actually build?

I build systems that sit between messy real-world inputs and clean outputs — APIs, pipelines, and automation layers that make things reliable.

What kind of problems do you enjoy?

Integration problems, data normalization, and systems that require both technical depth and product thinking.

Additional Information

Currently exploring AI-assisted workflow systems and autonomous training analysis.